

A Billion PCs By 2010

Research agencies IDC and Gartner say the number of PCs the world over will touch one billion by 2010. But, manufacturers must adapt the PC to local usage, battle government sanctions, and also create awareness in emerging markets.



No More CeBIT America

The CeBIT America show, slated for June 28 to June 30, 2005, has been called off. It could not raise enough revenue to justify a third year. CeBIT America would now concentrate on the enterprise segment and organise a show along the lines of Comdex.



Illustration: Anil Deshmukh

Enter

Amrita Rao

The *Ishq Vishq* Girl

She has since been seen in *Main Hoon Na*, this year's biggest domestic grosser; in the Vivek Oberoi starrer *Masti*; and will feature in *Deewar* later this year.

What does technology mean to you?

Innovation. It also means interacting with my fans and keeping in touch with them real-time.

What gadgets do you own?

A Sony PDA, a Samsung DVD player and a Nokia cellphone.

Which Web sites are you regular on?

I visit a few Bollywood entertainment sites like bollywoodworld.com and planetbollywood.com, etc.

Do you store your holiday memories on a CD, say a video you shot with your family abroad?

Yes. I prefer storing on a CD because they will stay with me for a long time, and in good quality. Besides I can store more.

Do you think technology is only for geeks?

Everyone interacts with technology every day. You can even book rail and cinema tickets online. This just shows how even the smallest, simplest thing in life is made easier due to technology.

Are you updated on the latest technology trends?

I do like to keep myself updated on MP3 players, digital cameras, and the latest computer peripherals.

Aparna Krishnakumar

YOU ARE GONNA GET ZAPPED SOON

Virus In Your Handheld

The wait is over, but for the wrong reasons. A Trojan Horse program called Backdoor.Brador.A, or WinCE.Brador.a, has arrived. It infects palmtops running the Pocket PC OS. The program arrives buried in an ordinary program, and once the former is installed, it is activated. It then uses the Internet connection from the infected device to send a message to the entity that planted it. That entity then gets to retrieve or delete data from the compromised device. If the palmtop is connected to a desktop computer, the desktop would be under the attacker's control as well.

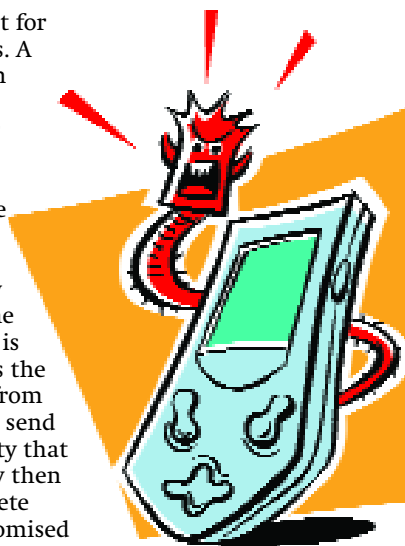


Illustration: Mahesh Benkar

However, Symantec rated the threat as level 1, the lowest on its five-point scale. The popular security

firm stresses that the program's efficacy is limited merely to devices using an ARM processor and the Pocket PC OS.

Antivirus firm Kaspersky Labs said the Trojan was probably written by a Russian coder.

"We were certain that a viable malicious program for PDAs would appear soon after the first proof-of-concept viruses emerged for mobile phones and Windows Mobile," said Eugene Kaspersky, head of Anti-Virus Research at Kaspersky Labs.

In this issue (page 44), we have discussed the upcoming threats to smartphones—and this report is just the beginning, as Dr Kaspersky fears.

PORN BLOGGERS' EXCUSE

That's Not My Porn

On August 3, Wired News reported that porn blogs were manipulating Google's Page Rankings. The report said a firm called CyberQuest was responsible for the marketing. It had set up a "few dozen" cross-linked and porn-themed blogs on Google-owned Blogspot. The blogs linked to three of CyberQuest's porn sites. Many experienced bloggers feel that the purpose

behind it all was to artificially raise the Page Rankings of the porn sites.

"It's the latest sleazy porn marketing scheme," said John

d'Addario, editor of Gawker Media's porn-themed gossip blog, *Fleshbot*. "It's another example of porn folk being sort of ahead of the curve when it comes to technology and marketing."

The whole ploy brings back memories of early porn-marketing techniques in which porn operators used meta-tagging to

outwit search engines.

Later, on August 5, CyberQuest vehemently denied the accusations, blaming the episode on "an affiliate".

CyberQuest owner Fade Saab told Wired News that until that day, he had been unaware of what was going on.

Headlines such as "Porn blogs

manipulate Google" have been doing the rounds lately. It is surprising to see a flat denial—"it was done by an affiliate" is as lame an excuse as they come.

"It's another example of porn folk being sort of ahead of the curve when it comes to technology and marketing."